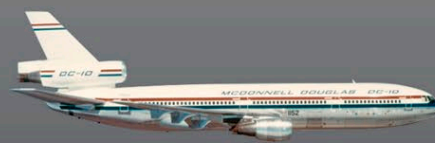




M-2



DC-2



DC-10



F-15 Eagle

1892 Donald Douglas is born in New York.

1914 Douglas is awarded the first-ever BSc in aeronautical engineering from MIT.

1921 The Douglas Aircraft Company is founded at Santa Monica, California.

1923 The US Army Air Service orders four converted DT torpedo bombers.

1924 Now renamed Douglas World Cruisers, the aircraft circumnavigates the globe.

1926 The Douglas M-2 mailplane is delivered.

1934 The DC-2 is successfully launched.

1936 The DC-3 first enters service.

1938 The prototype DC-4E flies. It is advanced for its time but is not successful.

1942 Douglas debuts the DC-4, larger than the -3 but smaller and simpler than the -4E. All of the early production aircraft go to the USAAF as the C-54 Skymaster.

1944 Production of the military version of the DC-3—the C-47 Skytrain—peaks, with 4,853 delivered that year.

1947 Douglas's first jet, the Skystreak, sets a new speed record of 641 mph (1,032 km/h).

1948 Douglas's first jet fighter, the F3D Skyknight night-fighter, flies.

1953 Flown by test pilot Albert Scott Crossfield, the Douglas Skyrocket is the first aircraft to exceed Mach 2.

1958 The prototype DC-8 flies. Although the 707 has entered service first the DC-8's six-abreast seating soon proves popular with the airlines.

1965 Flight testing begins on the DC-9. It enters service with Delta Airlines in December the same year.

1967 Douglas merges with the McDonnell Aircraft Corporation.

1971 The DC-10 enters service.

1972 A DC-10 experiences an explosive decompression caused by a flaw in the design of the cargo door.

1976 The F-15 Eagle is launched.

1981 Donald Douglas dies.

1984 The company buys Hughes Helicopters.

1986 The MD-11 is launched.

1997 McDonnell Douglas merges with The Boeing Company.



Bringing supplies to Berlin

In 1948 Douglas C-54 Skymasters were used to deliver food and coal to the people of West Berlin during the blockade of the city by the Russians.

D558-2 Skyrocket—being the first to exceed Mach 2. Douglas entered the jetliner age with the DC-8 series, while continuing to build fighters and rockets for the military. The DC-9 twin-jet followed, and Douglas began work on the three-engine DC-10 as a riposte to Boeing's 747 and Lockheed's L1011. The company was also busy producing A-4 Skyhawks for the US Navy, but despite a healthy order book, by 1966 the company was having cash-flow problems and merged with the McDonnell Aircraft Corporation to become McDonnell Douglas in 1967. The DC-10 was launched in 1971 and is still flying, although its reputation was blighted by several high-profile accidents in the 1970s. Another type produced by McDonnell Douglas, the F-4 Phantom, became one of the most successful Western jet fighters. It was followed by the F-15 Eagle, which also sold well, and the C-17 Globemaster II, a military transport launched in 1991.

After the death of Donald Douglas in 1981, the company moved into helicopter production, buying Hughes Helicopters. Its Apache attack helicopter was a success, while the missile division produced the Harpoon anti-ship missile and Tomahawk cruise missile. The F-18 Hornet also sold well, but the end of the Cold War hit the company hard, with several lucrative projects being cancelled. The civil division also suffered. The MD-11, an upgraded version of the DC-10 launched in 1986, never achieved great sales. In 1997 McDonnell Douglas was merged with The Boeing Company.